

out a way to put a reasonable amount extra on each payment until she was caught up.

The coach worked with her to develop a realistic budget, so she was able to live on her salary without accumulating more debt. At Beth's request, Jeri worked in a percentage she could give to her church, which would increase as she became closer to paying off her debts. By staying with the program, Beth will be debt-free within four years.

PENNY'S LIFE CHANGES

On Monday morning, Suzanne came directly to Penny's desk. "Got a minute?" she asked.

"Sure," Penny said, closing the door to her office. "What's up?"

"I wanted to ask you ... I went to this church over the weekend and I wondered if you'd come with me next week."

Penny was surprised. She had a church. Suzanne knew that. She didn't go every Sunday, but she went at least once a month and on all special days. Her religion was part of her upbringing, part of her family's roots for many generations back, even back to the old days in Europe. She was a good person, but definitely didn't believe in talking about religion—if a person was religious, it was fine, but Penny felt it should be kept to oneself. But Suzanne had become one of her best friends, and she wanted to please her.

"Well, maybe," she answered. "Oh, wait, I can't. This next Sunday is a memorial for a parishioner who died one year ago, so I have to be here."

"Actually, this church has a service on Saturday evening. I'd really like you to come with me. How about it?"

"Church on Saturday? This isn't one of those wacko places, is it?"

"No, of course not," Suzanne assured her. "Do you think I'd go somewhere like that?"

So Penny agreed. She and Suzanne went to New Life Community the following Saturday. Penny had never experienced anything like